

Neil Patterson

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING MANAGER

Hartford, Connecticut, USA

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Profile

Software Engineering Manager with 20+ years of experience building scalable web applications and leading distributed engineering teams across the US, Europe, and India. Combines deep Ruby on Rails and JavaScript expertise with a track record of developing engineers and technical leaders, improving reliability, and delivering complex SaaS product initiatives.

Core Competencies

Engineering Leadership	Engineering management, global teams, hiring, performance management, coaching, career development, Agile delivery, and stakeholder alignment
Architecture and Delivery	System design, scalable SaaS applications, reliability, incident management, observability, CI/CD, automated testing, and technical debt management
Application Development	Ruby, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, React, Next.js, APIs, GraphQL, AI-assisted development, AI agents, MCP, accessibility, and responsive design
Data and Platforms	PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, GCP, Datadog, and New Relic

Professional Experience

Finalsite

Glastonbury, CT, USA

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING MANAGER

2021–Present

- Lead distributed engineering teams across the US, Europe, and India, delivering reliable, scalable SaaS applications in a fast-paced product environment.
- Reduced the client-facing bug backlog by 25% through focused triage, stronger testing practices, and improved deployment workflows.
- Hire, coach, and develop engineers and technical leaders through performance management, career development, technical mentorship, and increased ownership.
- Built onboarding systems that enabled engineers to contribute production code within their first week.
- Partner with Product and Engineering leaders to translate business priorities into technical strategy, system design, and executable engineering plans.
- Drive AI adoption across engineering workflows, developing agents, skills, commands, and MCP-based tooling while promoting practical AI fluency across the organization.

SENIOR WEB DEVELOPER

2010–2021

- Led technical design and architecture for scalable web applications, establishing engineering practices for maintainability, performance, and code quality.
- Built and maintained production SaaS applications using Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, and MongoDB.
- Drove the transition from ColdFusion to Ruby on Rails, rapidly adopting the new stack and helping engineers migrate applications and development practices.
- Improved accessibility and responsive design across customer-facing applications while mentoring developers on technical design and engineering practices.

ORLive.com

West Hartford, CT, USA

WEB DEVELOPER

2005–2010

- Built medical CME learning management systems paired with medical-procedure broadcasts.
- Created a patient portal connecting prospective surgery patients with surgeons and hospitals, supporting monetization of broadcast marketing.

Timeframe, Inc.

Peterborough, NH, USA

GRAPHIC DESIGNER / WEB DEVELOPER

2003–2005

- Modernized a Lasso/FileMaker Pro customer portal to PHP/MySQL and automated online ordering, contributing to increased sales.
- Combined visual design, illustration, and web development in client-facing digital work.

Education

Keene State College

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, Keene, New Hampshire | 2001